

to avoid spam. This 10 e-mail limit rule does not apply to your friends on Gothpassions and you can chat with them till the Apocalypse or till your system gives up its ghost, whichever is earlier. A degree of secrecy is also enforced by keeping your pictures secret from non members and casual browsers.



Find your soul-vampire

Whenever you get a message or a notification you have a 'smooch' waiting for you. There are features like Gothic chats, webcam chats, audio chats, IM services, blogs and horoscopes. Forums are a big draw at Gothpassions and topics of discussion range from topics like Horror movies to occult and Goth poetry. Music videos can be uploaded to your profile and the other networking sites (MySpace, Flickr etc) where you spend your time can be added. Active and newly joined members are on the homepage and so are the active topics at the forums.

As regards user experience we were put off by the template. The placement of ads could have been more subtle. Instead they scream out and almost lead you to believe that they are part of the page.

This tactics might bring in ad revenue, but for users is pretty irritating. The links on the site are cluttered and the designers could have spent more time in managing real estate on the pages. Another problem is that the login facility is sometimes disabled. This is hardcore niche and is definitely not for everyone. But then again, our brief was not to find the site next door.